

Strong Years program

Balance & Steady Feet



Otago-style leg strength and balance practice plus simplified tai chi, to help you feel steadier on your feet.
12 weeks · four levels · every session scripted.

Chang Yin & Sun Yoon

Chang Yin and Sun Yoon are AI characters created by a team of people. Their life story is fiction. The exercises and recipes are built on published research for older adults (sources in the back). This is education, not medical advice. Check with your doctor before starting new exercise.

Balance & Steady Feet: how it works

Chang Yin

I'm Chang. AI character. Twelve weeks, one program, done properly. Otago-style leg strength and balance practice plus simplified tai chi, to help you feel steadier on your feet.

A little more, slowly. That's the whole method.

Who it's for. Adults 60+ who want to feel steadier on their feet and more confident on stairs, curbs and uneven ground. Every exercise is done at the kitchen counter.

Ask your doctor first if: Dizziness or fainting, a fall with injury or head strike (especially on blood thinners), sudden new unsteadiness, or new numbness: see your doctor first. Using a walker: start at Rebuild, with both hands on the counter.

What you need. Kitchen counter, sturdy chair against a wall, a rolled bath towel, stairs with a rail (optional), shoes with grippy soles.

Every day: Stop if you feel chest pain or pressure, dizziness, unusual shortness of breath, or sharp pain. Chest pain, face drooping, arm weakness or trouble speaking? Call 911 now. Pain rule (E41): Mild discomfort up to 3 out of 10 is okay if it settles by tomorrow. Sharper, or worse the next day: back off and ask your doctor or physical therapist.

Your week

Mon: strength · Tue: program session A · Wed: balance · Thu: program session B · Fri: breath + qigong · Sat: walk-and-talk · Sun: rest + stretch. Program sessions are marked in **bold** in the plan; the other days use your Strong Years Daily Practice sessions (DP numbers).

How it progresses

Three 4-week phases: **Foundation** (weeks 1–4, A1/B1), **Build** (weeks 5–8, A2/B2) and **Strengthen** (weeks 9–12, A3/B3).

Week in each phase	Rule
1st	Doses as written in the session. Learn the moves. Stop each set with one or two good reps left in the tank.
2nd	Add 1–2 reps per set (never past 12). Holds up 5 seconds (never past 30).
3rd	Where every rep felt easy two sessions in a row, use the Harder version or a heavier jug. Otherwise repeat week 2.
4th (easy week)	Easy week: same moves, one set fewer. Then do your checkpoint at the weekend.

Levels. Every session has four versions: Rebuild (chair-based), Steady, Strong and Iron. Move up only when every rep felt easy two sessions in a row. Move down any day. **Advanced** doses are never a starting point.

The 12-week plan

Week	Phase	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
1	Foundation	DP01	BAL-A1	DP03	BAL-B1	DP05	DP06	DP07
2	Foundation	DP04	BAL-A1	DP10	BAL-B1	DP12	DP13	DP14
3	Foundation	DP08	BAL-A1	DP17	BAL-B1	DP19	DP20	DP21
4 ★	Foundation	DP11	BAL-A1	DP24	BAL-B1	DP26	DP27	DP28
5	Build	DP15	BAL-A2	DP03	BAL-B2	DP05	DP06	DP07
6	Build	DP18	BAL-A2	DP10	BAL-B2	DP12	DP13	DP14
7	Build	DP22	BAL-A2	DP17	BAL-B2	DP19	DP20	DP21
8 ★	Build	DP25	BAL-A2	DP24	BAL-B2	DP26	DP27	DP28
9	Strengthen	DP29	BAL-A3	DP03	BAL-B3	DP05	DP06	DP07
10	Strengthen	DP01	BAL-A3	DP10	BAL-B3	DP12	DP13	DP14
11	Strengthen	DP04	BAL-A3	DP17	BAL-B3	DP19	DP20	DP21
12 ★	Strengthen	DP08	BAL-A3	DP24	BAL-B3	DP26	DP27	DP28

★ = easy week, then checkpoint. **Bold** = program session. DP = Daily Practice session number (sessions.json).

Red flags: Not for exercise. For your doctor, today: chest pain or pressure; fainting; sudden weakness or numbness in the face, arm or leg; trouble speaking; a sudden severe headache; new confusion; one calf that is swollen, red and painful; a hot, swollen joint; night pain that wakes you and doesn't change with position; fever with back pain; loss of bladder or bowel control or numbness in the saddle area; a fall where you hit your head (especially on blood thinners). Chest pain, face drooping, arm weakness or trouble speaking? Call 911 now.

Your checkpoints

Start, then the end of weeks 4, 8 and 12. Same chair, same shoes, same time of day. These are fitness checks from published research, **not medical tests**.

Checkpoint	How	Start	Week 4	Week 8	Week 12
Four-stage balance (E50)	Last stage held 10 s (0–4). Under 10 s on heel-to-toe is worth mentioning to your doctor (CDC screening checkpoint)				
Timed Up and Go (E51)	Seconds, normal pace, helper beside you. 12 s or more = tell your doctor				
One-leg stand (E09)	Seconds up to 30, hand hovering over the counter, each leg				
30-second chair stand (E11)	Full stands				
Confidence on your feet (self-rating)	0–10: stairs, curbs, getting up at night, walking on grass				

The program sessions

Full follow-along scripts for the six program sessions. The same content is in programs.json for the app and video pipeline.

BAL-A1 • Phase 1 (Foundation): Otago foundations

Type	Length	Set	Wardrobe	Voices
Balance & Steady Feet program	9:15	SET-KITCHEN	C-TRAIN-B	Chang

On screen the whole session: the "AI character" corner tag. In the first 30 seconds and before each hard block: "Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain."

Gentle-day swaps (the sore knee / sore back / low energy button): **Sore knee:** Use the Rebuild version of any standing leg move; skip floor practice and stairs today. **Sore back:** Seated versions of hinges and carries; keep every bend long-backed. **Low energy:** Do the warm-up, the first two blocks and the cool-down.

Run of show

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
0:00-0:35	Welcome	All levels together			
0:35-1:20	Weight shifts	5 each way, seated	6 each way	8 each way	8 each way, hand hovering

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
1:20–2:20	Seated knee straightening	1 set of 8 each leg	2 sets of 8 each leg	2 sets of 10 each leg	2 sets of 10 each leg, 3-second hold
2:20–3:10	Side steps Side steps along the counter	1 set of 6 each way	2 sets of 10 each way	2 sets of 10 each way, knees bent	2 sets of 12 each way, knees bent
3:10–4:20	Heel-to-toe stand Heel-to-toe stand at the counter	3 × 10 seconds each side, half-step	3 × 10 seconds each side	3 × 15 seconds each side, hand hovering	3 × 20 seconds each side, hands hovering
4:20–5:30	One-leg stand One-leg stand at the counter	3 × 10 seconds each side, toe down	3 × 10 seconds each side	3 × 15 seconds each side, hand hovering	3 × 20 seconds each side, hands hovering
5:30–6:30	Heel-to-toe walk Heel-to-toe walk along the counter	2 lengths, feet apart	2 lengths	2 lengths, hand hovering	3 lengths, hand hovering
6:30–7:30	Toe and heel walks Toe walk along the counter	<i>Heel raises at the counter:</i> 10 seated heel raises + 10 toe lifts	10 heel raises + 10 toe lifts at the counter	1 length toes + 1 length heels	2 lengths toes + 2 heels
7:30–8:15	Sit-to-stand, no hands Sit-to-stand without hands (balance version)	<i>Chair sit-to-stand:</i> 1 set of 5	1 set of 6	2 sets of 6	2 sets of 6, feet together
8:15–8:50	Cyclic sighing	35 seconds	35 seconds	35 seconds	35 seconds

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
8:50–9:15	Close	All levels together			

Script

0:00–0:35 • Welcome

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:00	Chang	Balance and Steady Feet. Phase one.	Balance · A1
0:10	Chang	These moves come from the Otago home program: leg strength, balance and walking, built for people in their 70s and 80s. Balance is one of the most trainable things there is.	Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain
0:17	Chang	We live at the counter. Hands hover, they don't wander.	Hands hover, they don't wander
0:24	Chang	Chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain: stop, sit, and call your doctor.	

0:35–1:20 • Weight shifts

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:35	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Weight shifts
0:45	Chang	Slowly shift your weight to your right foot. Pause.	Easier: Do it seated
0:52	Chang	Move from your ankles and hips, like a tree swaying.	
0:59	Chang	Feet stay flat on the floor.	
1:06	Chang	Breathe slowly.	

Cues: Move from your ankles and hips, like a tree swaying. Feet stay flat on the floor. **Easier:** Do it seated: shift your weight side to side on the chair. **Harder:** Make the shifts bigger, or let one hand hover.

1:20–2:20 • Seated knee straightening

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:20	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Seated knee straightening
1:32	Chang	Straighten your right knee until your leg is level, or as close as you can.	Easier: Straighten halfway
1:42	Chang	Toes point to the ceiling.	
1:47	Chang	One... two... breathe out... three... slow down... four.	
1:51	Chang	Squeeze, then lower slowly.	
2:01	Chang	Breathe out as you straighten your leg.	

Cues: Toes point to the ceiling. Squeeze, then lower slowly. **Easier:** Straighten only halfway. **Harder:** Hold for 5 seconds at the top, or add a light ankle weight later.

2:20–3:10 • Side steps

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
2:20	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Side steps
2:31	Chang	Step sideways to the right, then bring your left foot to meet it.	Easier: Fewer, slower steps
2:39	Chang	Stay tall.	
2:42	Chang	One... two... breathe out... three... slow down... four.	

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
2:47	Chang	Small, controlled steps.	
2:55	Chang	Breathe normally. Talk or count out loud.	

Cues: Stay tall. Small, controlled steps. Feet don't cross. **Easier:** Fewer steps, slower. **Harder:** Bend your knees slightly and stay low, or tie a resistance loop above your knees.

3:10–4:20 • Heel-to-toe stand

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
3:10	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Heel-to-toe stand
3:24	Chang	Place one foot directly in front of the other, heel touching toe.	Easier: Half-step, both hands down
3:35	Chang	Eyes on something still at eye level.	
3:46	Chang	Soft knees. Tall head.	
3:57	Chang	Breathe slowly and steadily.	

Cues: Eyes on something still at eye level. Soft knees. Tall head. **Easier:** Half-step stance: front foot's heel beside the big toe of the back foot. Both hands on the counter. **Harder:** Lift one hand to hover just above the counter. Later: both hands hovering.

Safety callouts: Balance drills always start with support. Hands hover, they don't wander away from the counter.

4:20–5:30 • One-leg stand

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
4:20	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	One-leg stand

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
4:34	Chang	Shift your weight to your left foot.	Easier: Toe stays on the floor
4:45	Chang	Stand tall. Don't lean on the counter.	
4:56	Chang	Squeeze the buttock of the standing leg.	
5:07	Chang	Breathe slowly. Count out loud.	

Cues: Stand tall. Don't lean on the counter. Squeeze the buttock of the standing leg. **Easier:** Just shift your weight onto one foot, keeping the other toe lightly on the floor. **Harder:** One hand hovering above the counter, then both hands hovering, right next to the counter.

Safety callouts: No barefoot drills on slippery floors, no socks on hard floors, no rugs under your feet.

5:30–6:30 • Heel-to-toe walk

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
5:30	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Heel-to-toe walk
5:42	Chang	Step forward, placing your heel directly in front of the toes of the other foot.	Easier: Feet apart, hold the counter
5:52	Chang	Eyes forward, not down at your feet.	
6:01	Chang	Slow is correct.	
6:11	Chang	Breathe steadily.	

Cues: Eyes forward, not down at your feet. Slow is correct. **Easier:** Walk with your feet slightly apart, not touching, holding the counter. **Harder:** Let your hand hover above the counter. Later: walk backward along the counter with one hand resting on it (normal steps).

6:30–7:30 • Toe and heel walks

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
6:30	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Toe and heel walks
6:42	Chang	Rise onto the balls of your feet.	Easier: Heel raises in place
6:52	Chang	Tall.	
7:01	Chang	Small steps.	
7:11	Chang	Breathe steadily.	

Cues: Tall. Small steps. **Easier:** Heel raises in place instead. **Harder:** Hand hovering, still right next to the counter.

Safety callouts: Calf cramps are common at first. Stretch and walk them out. One calf that is swollen, red and painful is not a cramp: that is for your doctor, today.

7:30–8:15 • Sit-to-stand, no hands

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:30	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Sit-to-stand, no hands
7:40	Chang	Sit with feet slightly narrower than usual.	Easier: Hands on thighs
7:47	Chang	Find your balance at the top before you move.	
7:50	Chang	One... two... breathe out... three... slow down... four.	
7:54	Chang	Slow down.	
8:01	Chang	Breathe out as you stand.	

Cues: Find your balance at the top before you move. Slow down. **Easier:** Use your hands on your thighs. **Harder:** Feet together.

8:15–8:50 • Cyclic sighing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:15	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Cyclic sighing
8:23	Chang	Breathe in through your nose.	Easier: Just slow nose breathing
8:29	Chang	Two sniffs in, one long sigh out.	
8:34	Chang	No holding at any point.	
8:40	Chang	The out-breath is always longer than the in-breath. No breath holds.	

Cues: Two sniffs in, one long sigh out. No holding at any point. **Easier:** Just breathe slowly through your nose, making the out-breath a little longer. **Harder:** Build up to 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, return to normal breathing.

8:50–9:15 • Close

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:50	Chang	Steady feet are trained feet.	
9:03	Chang	Toothbrush balance tonight. Hand on the sink.	

BAL-B1 • Phase 1 (Foundation): Tai chi: shifting and clouds

Type	Length	Set	Wardrobe	Voices
Balance & Steady Feet program	9:40	SET-YARD	C-TRAIN-B	Chang

On screen the whole session: the "AI character" corner tag. In the first 30 seconds and before each hard block: "Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain."

Gentle-day swaps (the sore knee / sore back / low energy button): **Sore knee:** Use the Rebuild version of any standing leg move; skip floor practice and stairs today. **Sore back:** Seated versions of hinges and carries; keep every bend long-backed. **Low energy:** Do the warm-up, the first two blocks and the cool-down.

Run of show

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
0:00-0:35	Welcome	All levels together			
0:35-1:35	Cyclic sighing	1 minute	1 minute	1 minute	1 minute
1:35-2:35	Weight shifts	6 each way, seated	8 each way	8 each way, bigger	10 each way, hand hovering

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
2:35–4:35	Cloud hands Cloud hands (tai chi, simplified)	2 minutes, seated	2 minutes, near the fence	2 minutes	2 minutes with side steps
4:35–6:15	Brush knee Brush knee (tai chi, simplified)	4 each side, arms only	4 each side	6 each side	4 steps across and back
6:15–7:15	Holding up the sky Holding up the sky (baduanjin piece 1)	4 reps, seated	5 reps	6 reps	6 reps, rise onto toes
7:15–8:15	Heel-to-toe stand Heel-to-toe stand at the counter	2 × 10 seconds each side, half-step	2 × 15 seconds each side	2 × 20 seconds each side, hand hovering	2 × 30 seconds each side, hands hovering
8:15–9:15	4-6 breathing	1 minute	1 minute	1 minute	1 minute
9:15–9:40	Close	All levels together			

Script

0:00–0:35 • Welcome

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:00	Chang	Tai chi day. Taught as exercise.	Balance • B1
0:10	Chang	Tai chi is slow balance practice: weight shifts, short steps and turns, done with control. We start small.	Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:17	Chang	Fence or counter within reach. Chair behind you.	Slow like honey
0:24	Chang	Chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain: stop, sit, and call your doctor.	

0:35–1:35 • Cyclic sighing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:35	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Cyclic sighing
0:47	Chang	Breathe in through your nose.	Easier: Just slow nose breathing
0:57	Chang	Two sniffs in, one long sigh out.	
1:06	Chang	No holding at any point.	
1:16	Chang	The out-breath is always longer than the in-breath. No breath holds.	

Cues: Two sniffs in, one long sigh out. No holding at any point. **Easier:** Just breathe slowly through your nose, making the out-breath a little longer. **Harder:** Build up to 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, return to normal breathing.

1:35–2:35 • Weight shifts

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:35	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Weight shifts
1:47	Chang	Slowly shift your weight to your right foot. Pause.	Easier: Do it seated

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:57	Chang	Move from your ankles and hips, like a tree swaying.	
2:06	Chang	Feet stay flat on the floor.	
2:16	Chang	Breathe slowly.	

Cues: Move from your ankles and hips, like a tree swaying. Feet stay flat on the floor. **Easier:** Do it seated: shift your weight side to side on the chair. **Harder:** Make the shifts bigger, or let one hand hover.

2:35–4:35 • Cloud hands

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
2:35	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Cloud hands
2:57	Chang	Shift your weight to the right foot while your right hand floats across in front of your face and your left hand floats low in front of your belly.	Easier: Seated, or one hand on counter
3:16	Chang	Move from your waist and legs, not just your arms.	
3:35	Chang	In tai chi we call it sinking: really, it's lowering your center of mass. Soft knees.	
3:54	Chang	Breathe slowly; no need to match the breath to the moves.	

Cues: Move from your waist and legs, not just your arms. In tai chi we call it sinking: really, it's lowering your center of mass. Soft knees. **Easier:** Keep one hand on the counter and move the other hand only. **Harder:** Add a small side step with each shift, next to the counter.

4:35–6:15 • Brush knee

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
4:35	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Brush knee
4:54	Chang	Step forward with the left foot, heel first, into a short stance.	Easier: Arms only, feet together
5:10	Chang	Short step, not a lunge.	
5:26	Chang	Weight moves slowly from back foot to front foot.	
5:42	Chang	Breathe out as you push forward.	

Cues: Short step, not a lunge. Weight moves slowly from back foot to front foot. **Easier:** Arms only, feet together, one hand on the counter. **Harder:** Four steps across the room and back, near the counter.

6:15–7:15 • Holding up the sky

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
6:15	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Holding up the sky
6:27	Chang	Breathe in and lift your hands slowly up the front of your body, turning palms to the ceiling as they pass your face.	Easier: Seated, to shoulder height
6:37	Chang	Slow, like moving through warm water.	
6:42	Chang	One... two... breathe out... three... slow down... four.	
6:46	Chang	Look straight ahead.	
6:56	Chang	Breathe in as the hands rise, out as they come down.	

Cues: Slow, like moving through warm water. Look straight ahead. **Easier:** Sit and do it seated, or lift only to shoulder height. **Harder:** Rise onto your toes a little at the top, holding the chair back with one hand if needed.

Safety callouts: Shoulder pain or a known rotator cuff problem? Only lift to a comfortable height, or skip it.

7:15–8:15 • Heel-to-toe stand

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:15	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Heel-to-toe stand
7:27	Chang	Place one foot directly in front of the other, heel touching toe.	Easier: Half-step, both hands down
7:37	Chang	Eyes on something still at eye level.	
7:46	Chang	Soft knees. Tall head.	
7:56	Chang	Breathe slowly and steadily.	

Cues: Eyes on something still at eye level. Soft knees. Tall head. **Easier:** Half-step stance: front foot's heel beside the big toe of the back foot. Both hands on the counter. **Harder:** Lift one hand to hover just above the counter. Later: both hands hovering.

Safety callouts: Balance drills always start with support. Hands hover, they don't wander away from the counter.

8:15–9:15 • 4-6 breathing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:15	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	4-6 breathing
8:27	Chang	Breathe in through your nose for a count of 4.	Easier: In for 3, out for 4

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:37	Chang	Belly rises first.	
8:46	Chang	Soft shoulders.	
8:56	Chang	In for 4, out for 6. That is about 6 breaths a minute. No holds.	

Cues: Belly rises first. Soft shoulders. **Easier:** In for 3, out for 4. **Harder:** Continue for 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, go back to normal breathing.

9:15–9:40 • Close

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
9:15	Chang	Slow like honey. Soft knees.	
9:28	Chang	Weekend: walk.	

BAL-A2 · Phase 2 (Build): Otago steps

Type	Length	Set	Wardrobe	Voices
Balance & Steady Feet program	8:25	SET-KITCHEN	C-TRAIN-B	Chang

On screen the whole session: the "AI character" corner tag. In the first 30 seconds and before each hard block: "Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain."

Gentle-day swaps (the sore knee / sore back / low energy button): **Sore knee:** Use the Rebuild version of any standing leg move; skip floor practice and stairs today. **Sore back:** Seated versions of hinges and carries; keep every bend long-backed. **Low energy:** Do the warm-up, the first two blocks and the cool-down.

Run of show

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
0:00-0:35	Welcome	All levels together			
0:35-1:15	Weight shifts	5 each way, seated	6 each way	8 each way	8 each way, hand hovering

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
1:15– 2:15	Backward walk Backward walk along the counter	<i>Weight shifts:</i> 6 front-to-back shifts, seated	5 small steps, twice	2 × 10 steps	3 × 10 steps, slower
2:15– 3:15	Step over a towel Step over a rolled towel	<i>Seated march:</i> 10 high knee lifts, seated	8 each way	8 forward and back	10 forward and back
3:15– 4:10	Clock reach	3 each way, front and side	4 each direction	4 each direction, one foot at 12	5 each direction, one foot at 12
4:10– 5:20	One-leg stand One-leg stand at the counter	3 × 15 seconds each side, toe down	3 × 15 seconds each side	3 × 20 seconds each side, hand hovering	3 × 30 seconds each side, hands hovering
5:20– 6:40	Stair practice Stair practice with the rail	<i>Seated march:</i> 2 × 30 seconds, knees high	Bottom 3 steps, 3 times	1 flight, twice	2 flights
6:40– 7:25	Heel raises Heel raises at the counter	2 sets of 10, seated	2 sets of 10	2 sets of 12, one hand	2 sets of 8 each leg
7:25– 8:00	Cyclic sighing	35 seconds	35 seconds	35 seconds	35 seconds
8:00– 8:25	Close	All levels together			

Script

0:00–0:35 • Welcome

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:00	Chang	Phase two. New steps.	Balance · A2
0:10	Chang	Backward, over, around. Every step next to the counter.	Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain
0:17	Chang	Shoes on. Clear floor.	
0:24	Chang	Chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain: stop, sit, and call your doctor.	

0:35–1:15 • Weight shifts

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:35	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Weight shifts
0:44	Chang	Slowly shift your weight to your right foot. Pause.	Easier: Do it seated
0:50	Chang	Move from your ankles and hips, like a tree swaying.	
0:57	Chang	Feet stay flat on the floor.	
1:03	Chang	Breathe slowly.	

Cues: Move from your ankles and hips, like a tree swaying. Feet stay flat on the floor. **Easier:** Do it seated: shift your weight side to side on the chair. **Harder:** Make the shifts bigger, or let one hand hover.

1:15–2:15 • Backward walk

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:15	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Backward walk
1:27	Chang	Take normal-size steps backward, toe then heel.	Easier: Five small steps
1:37	Chang	Hand stays on the counter.	
1:46	Chang	Slow. Look where you're going first.	
1:56	Chang	Breathe steadily.	

Cues: Hand stays on the counter. Slow. Look where you're going first.

Easier: Five small steps. **Harder:** Ten steps, slower.

Safety callouts: Only ever with a hand resting on the counter.

2:15–3:15 • Step over a towel

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
2:15	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Step over a towel
2:27	Chang	Step over the towel sideways with the near foot, then the other.	Easier: Flat towel
2:37	Chang	Lift the knee. Clear the towel.	
2:46	Chang	Hand on the counter.	
2:56	Chang	Breathe steadily.	

Cues: Lift the knee. Clear the towel. Hand on the counter. **Easier:** A flat towel instead of rolled. **Harder:** Step over forward and back, still holding the counter.

3:15–4:10 • Clock reach

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
3:15	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Clock reach
3:26	Chang	Reach your free arm forward to 12 o'clock. Back to center.	Easier: Smaller reaches, front and side
3:35	Chang	Follow your hand with your eyes.	
3:44	Chang	Feet stay planted.	
3:53	Chang	Breathe out as you reach.	

Cues: Follow your hand with your eyes. Feet stay planted. **Easier:** Smaller reaches, and only to the front and side. **Harder:** Stand on one foot while you reach to 12 o'clock, holding the counter.

Safety callouts: Osteoporosis? Turn gently and only as far as comfortable. Never force the twist.

4:10–5:20 • One-leg stand

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
4:10	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	One-leg stand
4:24	Chang	Shift your weight to your left foot.	Easier: Toe stays on the floor
4:35	Chang	Stand tall. Don't lean on the counter.	
4:46	Chang	Squeeze the buttock of the standing leg.	
4:57	Chang	Breathe slowly. Count out loud.	

Cues: Stand tall. Don't lean on the counter. Squeeze the buttock of the standing leg. **Easier:** Just shift your weight onto one foot, keeping the other toe lightly on the floor. **Harder:** One hand hovering above the counter, then both hands hovering, right next to the counter.

Safety callouts: No barefoot drills on slippery floors, no socks on hard floors, no rugs under your feet.

5:20–6:40 • Stair practice

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
5:20	Chang	Hand on the rail.	Stair practice
5:35	Chang	Walk up one step at a time at a steady pace, whole foot on each step.	Easier: Bottom 3 steps only
5:48	Chang	Whole foot on the step.	
6:01	Chang	Rail hand never lets go.	
6:14	Chang	Breathe steadily. Rest at the top as long as you like.	

Cues: Whole foot on the step. Rail hand never lets go. **Easier:** Just the bottom 3 steps, up and down. **Harder:** Two flights, or carry a light bag in the free hand.

Safety callouts: Chest pain or unusual breathlessness on stairs: stop, sit, and call your doctor.

6:40–7:25 • Heel raises

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
6:40	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Heel raises

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
6:50	Chang	Rise up onto the balls of your feet, as high as is comfortable.	Easier: Seated, or rise halfway
6:57	Chang	Tall like someone is pulling a string on top of your head.	
7:00	Chang	One... two... breathe out... three... slow down... four.	
7:04	Chang	Weight over the big toe and second toe, not rolling out.	
7:11	Chang	Breathe out as you rise.	

Cues: Tall like someone is pulling a string on top of your head. Weight over the big toe and second toe, not rolling out. **Easier:** Sit in your chair and raise your heels from there, or hold the counter with both hands and rise only halfway. **Harder:** One hand on the counter. Later: one leg at a time, with both hands on the counter.

Safety callouts: Calf cramps are common at first. Stretch and walk them out. One calf that is swollen, red and painful is not a cramp: that is for your doctor, today.

7:25–8:00 • Cyclic sighing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:25	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Cyclic sighing
7:33	Chang	Breathe in through your nose.	Easier: Just slow nose breathing
7:39	Chang	Two sniffs in, one long sigh out.	
7:44	Chang	No holding at any point.	

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:50	Chang	The out-breath is always longer than the in-breath. No breath holds.	

Cues: Two sniffs in, one long sigh out. No holding at any point. **Easier:** Just breathe slowly through your nose, making the out-breath a little longer. **Harder:** Build up to 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, return to normal breathing.

8:00–8:25 • Close

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:00	Chang	New steps, same counter.	
8:13	Chang	Tai chi on Thursday.	

BAL-B2 · Phase 2 (Build): Tai chi: three forms

Type	Length	Set	Wardrobe	Voices
Balance & Steady Feet program	9:20	SET-YARD	C-TRAIN-B	Chang

On screen the whole session: the "AI character" corner tag. In the first 30 seconds and before each hard block: "Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain."

Gentle-day swaps (the sore knee / sore back / low energy button): **Sore knee:** Use the Rebuild version of any standing leg move; skip floor practice and stairs today. **Sore back:** Seated versions of hinges and carries; keep every bend long-backed. **Low energy:** Do the warm-up, the first two blocks and the cool-down.

Run of show

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
0:00-0:35	Welcome	All levels together			
0:35-1:25	Cyclic sighing	50 seconds	50 seconds	50 seconds	50 seconds
1:25-2:55	Cloud hands Cloud hands (tai chi, simplified)	90 seconds, seated	90 seconds	90 seconds with side steps	2 minutes with side steps

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
2:55–4:25	Brush knee Brush knee (tai chi, simplified)	4 each side, arms only	6 each side	4 steps across and back	6 steps across and back
4:25–6:05	Parting the horse's mane Parting the horse's mane (tai chi, simplified)	4 each side, arms only	6 each side	4 steps across and back	6 steps across and back
6:05–6:55	Drawing the bow Drawing the bow (baduanjin piece 2, high stance)	3 each side, seated	4 each side	5 each side	5 each side, lower stance
6:55–7:55	One-leg stand One-leg stand at the counter	2 × 10 seconds each side, toe down	2 × 15 seconds each side	2 × 20 seconds each side, hand hovering	2 × 30 seconds each side, hands hovering
7:55–8:55	4-6 breathing	1 minute	1 minute	1 minute	1 minute
8:55–9:20	Close	All levels together			

Script

0:00–0:35 • Welcome

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:00	Chang	Tai chi, phase two. Three forms today.	Balance • B2
0:10	Chang	Cloud hands, brush knee, and parting the horse's mane.	Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:17	Chang	Fence within reach.	
0:24	Chang	Chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain: stop, sit, and call your doctor.	

0:35–1:25 • Cyclic sighing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:35	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Cyclic sighing
0:46	Chang	Breathe in through your nose.	Easier: Just slow nose breathing
0:54	Chang	Two sniffs in, one long sigh out.	
1:02	Chang	No holding at any point.	
1:10	Chang	The out-breath is always longer than the in-breath. No breath holds.	

Cues: Two sniffs in, one long sigh out. No holding at any point. **Easier:** Just breathe slowly through your nose, making the out-breath a little longer. **Harder:** Build up to 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, return to normal breathing.

1:25–2:55 • Cloud hands

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:25	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Cloud hands
1:42	Chang	Shift your weight to the right foot while your right hand floats across in front of your face and your left hand floats low in front of your belly.	Easier: Seated, or one hand on counter

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:56	Chang	Move from your waist and legs, not just your arms.	
2:11	Chang	In tai chi we call it sinking: really, it's lowering your center of mass. Soft knees.	
2:25	Chang	Breathe slowly; no need to match the breath to the moves.	

Cues: Move from your waist and legs, not just your arms. In tai chi we call it sinking: really, it's lowering your center of mass. Soft knees. **Easier:** Keep one hand on the counter and move the other hand only. **Harder:** Add a small side step with each shift, next to the counter.

2:55–4:25 • Brush knee

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
2:55	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Brush knee
3:12	Chang	Step forward with the left foot, heel first, into a short stance.	Easier: Arms only, feet together
3:26	Chang	Short step, not a lunge.	
3:41	Chang	Weight moves slowly from back foot to front foot.	
3:55	Chang	Breathe out as you push forward.	

Cues: Short step, not a lunge. Weight moves slowly from back foot to front foot. **Easier:** Arms only, feet together, one hand on the counter. **Harder:** Four steps across the room and back, near the counter.

4:25–6:05 • Parting the horse's mane

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
4:25	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Parting the horse's mane
4:44	Chang	Imagine holding a ball at your chest, right hand on top.	Easier: Arms only, hold the counter
5:00	Chang	Short step.	
5:16	Chang	Slow like honey.	
5:32	Chang	Breathe out as the arm sweeps up.	

Cues: Short step. Slow like honey. **Easier:** Arms only, feet together, holding the counter with one hand. **Harder:** Step forward across the room, left then right, near the counter.

6:05–6:55 • Drawing the bow

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
6:05	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Drawing the bow
6:16	Chang	Bring both hands in front of your chest.	Easier: Seated, arms only
6:24	Chang	Knees over toes.	
6:32	Chang	Grow tall through the top of the head.	
6:40	Chang	Breathe out as you draw the bow, in as you return.	

Cues: Knees over toes. Grow tall through the top of the head. **Easier:** Sit tall in your chair and do the arm movement only. **Harder:** Bend your knees a little more (never below comfortable).

6:55–7:55 • One-leg stand

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
6:55	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	One-leg stand
7:07	Chang	Shift your weight to your left foot.	Easier: Toe stays on the floor
7:17	Chang	Stand tall. Don't lean on the counter.	
7:26	Chang	Squeeze the buttock of the standing leg.	
7:36	Chang	Breathe slowly. Count out loud.	

Cues: Stand tall. Don't lean on the counter. Squeeze the buttock of the standing leg. **Easier:** Just shift your weight onto one foot, keeping the other toe lightly on the floor. **Harder:** One hand hovering above the counter, then both hands hovering, right next to the counter.

Safety callouts: No barefoot drills on slippery floors, no socks on hard floors, no rugs under your feet.

7:55–8:55 • 4-6 breathing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:55	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	4-6 breathing
8:07	Chang	Breathe in through your nose for a count of 4.	Easier: In for 3, out for 4
8:17	Chang	Belly rises first.	
8:26	Chang	Soft shoulders.	
8:36	Chang	In for 4, out for 6. That is about 6 breaths a minute. No holds.	

Cues: Belly rises first. Soft shoulders. **Easier:** In for 3, out for 4. **Harder:** Continue for 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, go back to normal breathing.

8:55–9:20 • Close

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:55	Chang	Three forms. Soft knees, slow weight shifts.	
9:08	Chang	Checkpoint at the end of week eight.	

BAL-A3 · Phase 3 (Strengthen): Steady in real life

Type	Length	Set	Wardrobe	Voices
Balance & Steady Feet program	8:40	SET-KITCHEN	C-TRAIN-B	Chang

On screen the whole session: the "AI character" corner tag. In the first 30 seconds and before each hard block: "Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain."

Gentle-day swaps (the sore knee / sore back / low energy button): **Sore knee:** Use the Rebuild version of any standing leg move; skip floor practice and stairs today. **Sore back:** Seated versions of hinges and carries; keep every bend long-backed. **Low energy:** Do the warm-up, the first two blocks and the cool-down.

Run of show

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
0:00-0:35	Welcome	All levels together			
0:35-1:15	Weight shifts	5 each way, seated	6 each way	8 each way	8 each way, hand hovering

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
1:15– 2:45	Floor practice Floor practice with a chair (kneel and rise)	<i>Chair sit-to-stand:</i> 1 set of 6 (no floor)	2 half-kneels each side	2 kneel-and-rise	2 sit-to-floor and rise
2:45– 3:45	Step over a towel Step over a rolled towel	<i>Seated march:</i> 12 high knee lifts, seated	8 forward and back	10 forward and back	12 forward and back
3:45– 4:45	Big-step drill Big-step walking drill	<i>Seated march:</i> 30 seconds, big knee lifts	2 × 10 steps along the counter	2 × 10 big steps	2 × 20 big steps
4:45– 5:45	Heel-to-toe walk Heel-to-toe walk along the counter	2 lengths, feet apart	3 lengths, hand hovering	4 lengths, hand hovering	4 lengths, hand hovering + 2 backward, hand on counter
5:45– 6:55	One-leg stand + reach Clock reach	<i>One-leg stand at the counter:</i> 3 × 15 seconds each side, toe down	4 each direction	4 reaches on one foot each side	6 reaches on one foot each side
6:55– 7:40	Sit-to-stand, no hands Sit-to-stand without hands (balance version)	<i>Chair sit-to-stand:</i> 2 sets of 5	2 sets of 6, feet together	2 sets of 8, feet together	3 sets of 8, feet together
7:40– 8:15	Cyclic sighing	35 seconds	35 seconds	35 seconds	35 seconds
8:15– 8:40	Close	All levels together			

Script

0:00–0:35 • Welcome

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:00	Chang	Phase three. Steady in real life.	Balance · A3
0:10	Chang	Floor practice, stepping, turning.	Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain
0:17	Chang	Someone home for the floor part.	
0:24	Chang	Chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain: stop, sit, and call your doctor.	

0:35–1:15 • Weight shifts

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:35	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Weight shifts
0:44	Chang	Slowly shift your weight to your right foot. Pause.	Easier: Do it seated
0:50	Chang	Move from your ankles and hips, like a tree swaying.	
0:57	Chang	Feet stay flat on the floor.	
1:03	Chang	Breathe slowly.	

Cues: Move from your ankles and hips, like a tree swaying. Feet stay flat on the floor. **Easier:** Do it seated: shift your weight side to side on the chair. **Harder:** Make the shifts bigger, or let one hand hover.

1:15–2:45 • Floor practice

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:15	Chang	Sturdy chair beside you. Towel down. Someone else home.	Floor practice
1:36	Chang	Kneel with your hands on the chair. Rise through the front foot.	Easier: Half-kneel only, or chair stands
1:54	Chang	Breathe out as you push up. Stand still before you walk.	Only with a sturdy chair and someone home
2:12	Chang	Practise getting up before you ever need to.	

Cues: Hands on the chair the whole time. Slow down. Up is a push, not a jump. **Easier:** Only the first step: lower into a half-kneel on the towel and come back up, holding the chair. Or skip the floor and do sit-to-stands.

Harder: Iron: from kneeling, sit down onto the floor beside the chair, then roll to your knees and rise with the chair. Only with someone home.

Safety callouts: Only try the floor with a sturdy chair or sofa next to you and someone home. Recent hip or knee replacement, or severe knee arthritis: follow your surgeon's or physical therapist's guidance first. New knee? Kneeling may not be allowed yet. Ask your surgeon. Sit a moment before you stand, then stand slowly while holding something steady.

2:45–3:45 • Step over a towel

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
2:45	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Step over a towel
2:57	Chang	Step over the towel sideways with the near foot, then the other.	Easier: Flat towel
3:07	Chang	Lift the knee. Clear the towel.	

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
3:16	Chang	Hand on the counter.	
3:26	Chang	Breathe steadily.	

Cues: Lift the knee. Clear the towel. Hand on the counter. **Easier:** A flat towel instead of rolled. **Harder:** Step over forward and back, still holding the counter.

3:45–4:45 • Big-step drill

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
3:45	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Big-step drill
3:57	Chang	Walk 10 steps a little longer than your normal step.	Easier: Normal steps, hand on counter
4:07	Chang	Heel, roll, push.	
4:16	Chang	Tall. Eyes ahead.	
4:26	Chang	Breathe steadily.	

Cues: Heel, roll, push. Tall. Eyes ahead. **Easier:** Normal-length steps, hand on the counter. **Harder:** 20 steps, a little faster.

4:45–5:45 • Heel-to-toe walk

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
4:45	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Heel-to-toe walk
4:57	Chang	Step forward, placing your heel directly in front of the toes of the other foot.	Easier: Feet apart, hold the counter
5:07	Chang	Eyes forward, not down at your feet.	

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
5:16	Chang	Slow is correct.	
5:26	Chang	Breathe steadily.	

Cues: Eyes forward, not down at your feet. Slow is correct. **Easier:** Walk with your feet slightly apart, not touching, holding the counter. **Harder:** Let your hand hover above the counter. Later: walk backward along the counter with one hand resting on it (normal steps).

5:45–6:55 • One-leg stand + reach

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
5:45	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	One-leg stand + reach
5:59	Chang	Reach your free arm forward to 12 o'clock. Back to center.	Easier: Smaller reaches, front and side
6:10	Chang	Follow your hand with your eyes.	
6:21	Chang	Feet stay planted.	
6:32	Chang	Breathe out as you reach.	

Cues: Follow your hand with your eyes. Feet stay planted. **Easier:** Smaller reaches, and only to the front and side. **Harder:** Stand on one foot while you reach to 12 o'clock, holding the counter.

Safety callouts: No barefoot drills on slippery floors, no socks on hard floors, no rugs under your feet. Osteoporosis? Turn gently and only as far as comfortable. Never force the twist.

6:55–7:40 • Sit-to-stand, no hands

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
6:55	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Sit-to-stand, no hands
7:05	Chang	Sit with feet slightly narrower than usual.	Easier: Hands on thighs
7:12	Chang	Find your balance at the top before you move.	
7:15	Chang	One... two... breathe out... three... slow down... four.	
7:19	Chang	Slow down.	
7:26	Chang	Breathe out as you stand.	

Cues: Find your balance at the top before you move. Slow down. **Easier:** Use your hands on your thighs. **Harder:** Feet together.

7:40–8:15 • Cyclic sighing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:40	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Cyclic sighing
7:48	Chang	Breathe in through your nose.	Easier: Just slow nose breathing
7:54	Chang	Two sniffs in, one long sigh out.	
7:59	Chang	No holding at any point.	
8:05	Chang	The out-breath is always longer than the in-breath. No breath holds.	

Cues: Two sniffs in, one long sigh out. No holding at any point. **Easier:** Just breathe slowly through your nose, making the out-breath a little longer. **Harder:** Build up to 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, return to normal breathing.

8:15–8:40 • Close

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:15	Chang	Floor, steps, turns. Real life.	
8:28	Chang	Tai chi Thursday.	

BAL-B3 · Phase 3 (Strengthen): Tai chi: the full flow

Type	Length	Set	Wardrobe	Voices
Balance & Steady Feet program	9:20	SET-PROM	C-TRAIN-B	Chang

On screen the whole session: the "AI character" corner tag. In the first 30 seconds and before each hard block: "Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain."

Gentle-day swaps (the sore knee / sore back / low energy button): **Sore knee:** Use the Rebuild version of any standing leg move; skip floor practice and stairs today. **Sore back:** Seated versions of hinges and carries; keep every bend long-backed. **Low energy:** Do the warm-up, the first two blocks and the cool-down.

Run of show

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
0:00-0:35	Welcome	All levels together			
0:35-1:25	Cyclic sighing	50 seconds	50 seconds	50 seconds	50 seconds

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
1:25–2:45	Flow round 1: cloud hands Cloud hands (tai chi, simplified)	80 seconds, seated	80 seconds	80 seconds with side steps	80 seconds with side steps
2:45–4:05	Flow round 1: brush knee Brush knee (tai chi, simplified)	4 each side, arms only	6 each side	4 steps across and back	6 steps across and back
4:05–5:25	Flow round 1: parting the mane Parting the horse's mane (tai chi, simplified)	4 each side, arms only	6 each side	4 steps across and back	6 steps across and back
5:25–7:55	Flow round 2: all three Cloud hands (tai chi, simplified)	Cloud hands, brush knee, parting the mane: arms only, seated	All three forms, 2 each	All three forms with steps	All three forms with steps, slower
7:55–8:55	4-6 breathing	1 minute	1 minute	1 minute	1 minute
8:55–9:20	Close	All levels together			

Script

0:00–0:35 • Welcome

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:00	Chang	Phase three. The full flow, three rounds.	Balance • B3

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:10	Chang	Rail within reach.	Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain
0:17	Chang	Slow like honey.	
0:24	Chang	Chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain: stop, sit, and call your doctor.	

0:35–1:25 • Cyclic sighing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:35	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Cyclic sighing
0:46	Chang	Breathe in through your nose.	Easier: Just slow nose breathing
0:54	Chang	Two sniffs in, one long sigh out.	
1:02	Chang	No holding at any point.	
1:10	Chang	The out-breath is always longer than the in-breath. No breath holds.	

Cues: Two sniffs in, one long sigh out. No holding at any point. **Easier:** Just breathe slowly through your nose, making the out-breath a little longer. **Harder:** Build up to 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, return to normal breathing.

1:25–2:45 • Flow round 1: cloud hands

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:25	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Flow round 1: cloud hands

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:40	Chang	Shift your weight to the right foot while your right hand floats across in front of your face and your left hand floats low in front of your belly.	Easier: Seated, or one hand on counter
1:53	Chang	Move from your waist and legs, not just your arms.	
2:06	Chang	In tai chi we call it sinking: really, it's lowering your center of mass. Soft knees.	
2:19	Chang	Breathe slowly; no need to match the breath to the moves.	

Cues: Move from your waist and legs, not just your arms. In tai chi we call it sinking: really, it's lowering your center of mass. Soft knees. **Easier:** Keep one hand on the counter and move the other hand only. **Harder:** Add a small side step with each shift, next to the counter.

2:45–4:05 • Flow round 1: brush knee

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
2:45	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Flow round 1: brush knee
3:00	Chang	Step forward with the left foot, heel first, into a short stance.	Easier: Arms only, feet together
3:13	Chang	Short step, not a lunge.	
3:26	Chang	Weight moves slowly from back foot to front foot.	
3:39	Chang	Breathe out as you push forward.	

Cues: Short step, not a lunge. Weight moves slowly from back foot to front foot. **Easier:** Arms only, feet together, one hand on the counter. **Harder:** Four steps across the room and back, near the counter.

4:05–5:25 • Flow round 1: parting the mane

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
4:05	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Flow round 1: parting the mane
4:20	Chang	Imagine holding a ball at your chest, right hand on top.	Easier: Arms only, hold the counter
4:33	Chang	Short step.	
4:46	Chang	Slow like honey.	
4:59	Chang	Breathe out as the arm sweeps up.	

Cues: Short step. Slow like honey. **Easier:** Arms only, feet together, holding the counter with one hand. **Harder:** Step forward across the room, left then right, near the counter.

5:25–7:55 • Flow round 2: all three

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
5:25	Chang	Near the rail. Now all three, one after another.	Flow round 2: all three
6:08	Chang	Cloud hands. Brush knee. Parting the mane.	Easier: Seated, or one hand on counter
6:48	Chang	Breathe slowly. Soft knees. Weight moves first, then the hands.	

Cues: Move from your waist and legs, not just your arms. In tai chi we call it sinking: really, it's lowering your center of mass. Soft knees. **Easier:** Keep one hand on the counter and move the other hand only. **Harder:** Add a small side step with each shift, next to the counter.

7:55–8:55 • 4-6 breathing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:55	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	4-6 breathing
8:07	Chang	Breathe in through your nose for a count of 4.	Easier: In for 3, out for 4
8:17	Chang	Belly rises first.	
8:26	Chang	Soft shoulders.	
8:36	Chang	In for 4, out for 6. That is about 6 breaths a minute. No holds.	

Cues: Belly rises first. Soft shoulders. **Easier:** In for 3, out for 4. **Harder:** Continue for 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, go back to normal breathing.

8:55–9:20 • Close

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:55	Chang	Twelve weeks. That's a flow you can keep for as long as you like.	
9:08	Chang	Final checkpoint this weekend.	

Where the numbers come from

Every number and health statement in this book traces to one of the entries below. They are the same evidence IDs our whole team uses (EVIDENCE.md). Grade A means a Cochrane review, a large meta-analysis or a guideline body. B means a single good trial or a small meta-analysis. C means an observational study: it shows a link, not cause and effect. D means lab, physiology or label data.

E09 (grade C). 10-second one-leg stance (free foot resting on the back of the other calf, arms at sides, 3 tries). 1,702 people aged 51–75. Failing it was linked with 84% higher all-cause mortality over about 7 years. Failure rates: about 18% at 61–65, about 37% at 66–70, over 50% at 71–75.

Source: Araújo et al., BJSM 2022 — <https://www.bristol.ac.uk/news/2022/june/tne-second-one-legged-stance.html>

E11 (grade A (tool)). CDC STEADI 30-second chair stand (17-inch chair, arms crossed), used in the CDC's older-adult screening. Below-average scores: men 60–64 <14, 65–69 <12, 70–74 <12, 75–79 <11, 80–84 <10, 85–89 <8, 90–94 <7. Women 60–64 <12, 65–69 <11, 70–74 <10, 75–79 <10, 80–84 <9, 85–89 <8, 90–94 <4. If arms are used to stand, the score is 0.

Source: CDC STEADI — <https://www.cdc.gov/steady/media/pdfs/STEADI-Assessment-30Sec-508.pdf>

E13 (grade A–). Otago Exercise Programme: a home programme of leg strengthening, balance exercises and walking designed for older adults, studied in 7 trials with 1,503 people (mean age 81.6). We use its exercise types and progressions; we make no outcome claim from it.

Source: Thomas et al., Age Ageing 2010 — <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/books/NBK78898/>

E15 (grade B+). Tai chi vs physical therapy for knee osteoarthritis: 204 adults. Similar improvements in pain and function at 12 weeks, sustained to 52 weeks. Tai chi group had more improvement in depression and quality of life.

Source: Wang et al., Ann Intern Med 2016 — <https://www.nccih.nih.gov/research/research-results/study-shows-tai-chi-and-physical-therapy-were-equally-helpful-for-knee-osteoarthritis>

E17 (grade A–). Baduanjin/qigong in older adults: meta-analyses report better sleep quality and fewer depressive symptoms (moderate certainty, heterogeneous trials).

Source: Frontiers Public Health 2026 meta-analysis — <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13501274/> ; qigong & sleep meta — <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12757222/>

E41 (grade B (known literature)). Pain-monitoring model: during and after exercise, pain up to about 3/10 (we use a conservative threshold) is acceptable if it settles by the next morning and isn't trending up week to week.

Source: Thomeé, Phys Ther 1997; Silbernagel et al., Am J Sports Med 2007

E42 (grade A (statement)). AHA scientific statement (2023): resistance training is recommended for adults with and without cardiovascular disease. It lowers blood pressure and improves glucose control and function. Avoid breath-holding (Valsalva). People with CVD should get individualized clearance.

Source: Paluch et al., Circulation 2024 — <https://www.ahajournals.org/doi/10.1161/CIR.0000000000001189>

E43 (grade A (guideline)). Pre-exercise screening (ACSM 2015): anyone with symptoms of cardiovascular, metabolic or renal disease (chest pain, unusual breathlessness, fainting) should get medical clearance before starting. Otherwise, light-to-moderate exercise can begin and progress.

Source: Riebe et al., Med Sci Sports Exerc 2015 (known literature)

E45 (grade B (known literature)). Getting-up-from-the-floor strategies can be taught to older adults. Practice it before you ever need it (backward chaining: kneel → half-kneel → stand, using sturdy furniture).

Source: Hofmeyer et al., J Am Geriatr Soc 2002 (floor-rise strategy training)

E50 (grade A (tool)). CDC STEADI 4-Stage Balance Test: feet side by side, semi-tandem (instep beside big toe), tandem (heel to toe), one leg; up to 10 s each, stop at the first stage not held. The CDC uses the tandem stand as a screening checkpoint: under 10 s is worth discussing with a clinician.

Source: CDC STEADI — opened <https://www.cdc.gov/steady/media/pdfs/STEADI-Assessment-4Stage-508.pdf>

E51 (grade A (tool)). CDC STEADI Timed Up and Go: stand from a chair, walk 10 feet (3 m) at normal pace, turn, walk back, sit. The CDC uses 12 seconds or more as a screening threshold worth discussing with a clinician. Always have someone stand by.

Source: CDC STEADI — opened <https://www.cdc.gov/steady/media/pdfs/STEADI-Assessment-TUG-508.pdf>